

# Imitation is the sincerest form of flattery...

## ...that mediocrity can pay to greatness.

That's the rest of the saying from Oscar Wilde, in case you didn't know, and in many ways I think that still applies today, especially to the video games industry. The problem is that we seem to be running short on greatness, and it's all mostly imitation now, which is a bit of a bummer.

It's not all bad though. Fortunately, not everyone is out to make an exact replica, they're willing to modify, add a thing or two; they've got their own vision of what great should look like, even if its conception had nothing to do with them. What this means is, when the next great thing comes along, you can bet that there will be several thousand clones of it. But there will be a few trying to make it even greater, and that's not really a bad thing, now is it?

When PUBG first exploded on the scene, it was the next great thing of its time. As a result, every game to release in the next three years incorporated a Battle Royale mode in some way or the other. It was like it was almost mandatory for it to be there. Of course, the only "imitations" that stood out were the ones that either did something different with the format, or improved upon it. Fortnite comes to mind with its building element; it eventually even surpassed the OG.

Before PUBG, there was Minecraft. We don't need to tell you about the influx of sandbox survival games that came after that. There's too many to name. Before Minecraft there was Dota, which spawned at least four fairly popular MOBAs that define esports today. Even before that, it was World of Warcraft, and so on and so forth. It's a cycle, and it's definitely not ending



anytime soon. What you'll notice though is that a fair number of these imitations go on to become more successful than the thing they're imitating. Of course, it doesn't apply to everything, but there are enough cases to prove my point.

This month's cover story is about imitations, in a way; imitations of Minecraft. It's interesting to see the differences between the imitator and the source, the result can be a fairly unique experience, or a twist on a familiar one. At the end of the day, it's for you to decide.

**—Manish “Trigger-Happy” Rajesh**

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